



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 3

ARKANSAS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Arkansas's family courts and child-welfare system.

31

ARKANSAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 40
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 22 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 30, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
11 OF 75

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ARKANSAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 31 Arkansas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 40 31 of 31 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$13,500 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 22 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 41.9% 25.8% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 31	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.3	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 31 of 31	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 11

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Arkansas families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF ARKANSAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	18	\$13,500	\$90,975	\$1,637,550
Lost Wages	16	\$55,000	\$367,812	\$5,885,000
Other Court Fees	11	\$3,200	\$29,798	\$327,780
Therapy / Evaluations	13	\$3,000	\$10,977	\$142,700
Reunification Services	11	\$0	\$882	\$9,700
GAL Fees	15	\$750	\$22,670	\$340,050
Asset Loss ¹	14	\$50,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$125,450	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		22 1.8 yrs
Mean months lost		31 2.6 yrs
Total across all families		626 52.2 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ARKANSAS

Most families documenting in Arkansas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		14	45%
Not provided		7	23%
Case closed: within last 2 years		5	16%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		5	16%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		17	55%
Family Court Only		6	19%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		4	13%
Unknown		4	13%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		12	39%
5 – 10 years		6	19%
3 – 5 years		5	16%
5+ years		3	10%
Over 10 years		2	6%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		12	39%
Visitation Only		8	26%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		5	16%
Full Custody		3	10%
50/50 Joint		1	3%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Lonoke		4	13%
Sebastian		3	10%
Boone		3	10%
Greene		2	6%
Pulaski		2	6%
Stormont Dundas Glengarry		1	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		14	45%
Other: (Short answer)		7	23%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		5	16%
Family Court		2	6%
Environmental/Poverty-Related (Lack of housing, utilities, etc.)		1	3%

05 PARENT VOICES — ARKANSAS

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Arkansas comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



Dhs-dcfs, child litem, casa fosters family court judge and attorneys

— ANTONIA

Ripped us apart, erased the God given fact that I gave birth to my son, utterly and completely destroyed the relationship between my only child and I. Made me out to be so.e ki d of criminal, crazy drug addict who was incapable of caring for her son.

— ANGELA

Instead of protecting our family and those at risk, DCFS and the juvenile justice system has fractured our family. The trauma experienced doesn't just impact us but it will impact my nieces and their children and their children's children.

— TAMARA

My children were removed from my care by the Arkansas Division of Family Services under circumstances that were both unfair and deeply distressing. For over a year, the agency made it nearly impossible for me to regain custody, despite my constant efforts to comply with every [...]

— CHARISSA

Severe mental trauma PTSD depression

— KEVIN

Bankrupted us we lost our home, boats, vehicles sanity and caused grievance fir lost time with our grand children

— BRENDA

They took a loving parent and gave them to an abusive parent.

— NICKI

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This is an America Family Genocide System!

— AUBREY

Him and the court has caused confusion with my children. Being alienated because your ex is beyond disgruntled and obsessed with destroying myself and my kids self esteem, security, and bond with their mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied under oath, broke my son's arm under care and still was able to adopt him, sent cruel messages and told me to sign my rights away

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have failed my son in every way possible including protecting him they removed based on false allegations and my other children miss their brother we want him located his safety verified and home where he is loved wanted missed and safe! I have everything ready and I'm so [...]

— AMY

I have four children in which one of my children is autistic level three nonverbal. He has not seen me in five months. I have not slept a good night sleep in over six months. I sleep for maybe two hours and I'm up for 22.

— BRITTANY

Lonoke Judge Parker should be reported and all his cases looked at by the law board. The whole court system in Lonoke County is ripping great loving mothers from thier children and allowing men to do anything they wish and make it a court order. How does he sleep at night.. on [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has torn my family apart my son's father has passed since this beginning of this and he didn't even get to grieve during this difficult time of loosing his dad which was his world

— STACEY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



I have lost everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I dropped my kids off at school and they never got off the bus. I was met outside my home with handcuffs to be taken to interrogation room. My youngest had no mental health problems and now she deals with severe separation anxiety from me. My oldest struggles to fight the [...]

— JENESSA

The court ignored my daughter's statements of sexual abuse and awarded custody to her abuser. She has since experienced SI. The court refused to acknowledge violations of court order.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Disregarded the laws and opened my eyes to realize the laws are seemingly made for civilians and not for government officials to follow. OR Do as I say, not as I do. They are judge and jury in a no jury, unlawful, overpowered bias system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've been being sued my Dad/Stepmom since 2018-2026 for full custody of my two daughters he got temporary custody of them and has had that now for 13 months

— CHRISTINE

It didn't listen to me when I said he'll move far away and then take the girls. That he'll just keep coming at me until they are 18 when he can't make money off of them

— JESSICA

It has been very insane the amount of families that are put through this that don't deserve it. They didn't give me a chance from the beginning offered no help but speedy court dates.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

21 Arkansas parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 21 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — ARKANSAS

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Arkansas families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

Dhs-dcfs, child litem, casa fosters family court judge and attorneys

— ANTONIA

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Instead of protecting our family and those at risk, DCFS and the juvenile justice system has fractured our family. The trauma experienced doesn't just impact us but it will impact my nieces and their children and their children's children.

— TAMARA

My children were removed from my care by the Arkansas Division of Family Services under circumstances that were both unfair and deeply distressing. For over a year, the agency made it nearly impossible for me to regain custody, despite my constant efforts to comply with every requirement and reunite with my children. When my children were taken, I immediately asked that they be placed with family members, but that request was refused. The department delayed setting up the counseling and support services that I was ordered to complete, even though I was ready and willing to participate. To make matters worse, they moved my children four hours away from me, knowing that I did not have a vehicle. This made it almost impossible to visit them regularly, no matter how much I wanted to. Throughout the process, I was portrayed inaccurately. In court, the department told the judge that I was not trying or cooperating, which was completely untrue. The Arkansas State Police later investigated the allegations that led to my children's removal and found them to be unfounded and untrue. Even with that finding, my children were never returned to my care. Eventually, I was pressured into signing away my parental rights — not because I wanted to, but because I was cornered and made to feel that I had no other choice. My children were adopted, and I live every day with the pain of knowing that the truth was ignored and that I did everything I could to bring them home. This experience has left me determined to speak up — for myself, for my children, and for other parents who are struggling to be heard and treated fairly.

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— KEVIN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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They have failed my son in every way possible including protecting him they removed based on false allegations and my other children miss their brother we want him located his safety verified and home where he is loved wanted missed and safe! I have everything ready and I'm so ready to fight the system that hurt our family the system that continues to fail so many children every day if you share because it's still pending please don't use names you can use my name

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21 full approved Arkansas comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT**WHAT THIS IS**

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Arkansas report comes from Arkansas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Arkansas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 31 Arkansas families reporting here are not the universe of Arkansas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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